

Full Name:

Semantics: Metaphor Tutorial

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1. Lakoff and Johnson (1980) proposed the following image schemas for love:

- LOVE IS A JOURNEY
- LOVE IS A FORCE (electromagnetic, gravitational)
- LOVE IS WAR

Organise the following metaphors into the above three schemas.

- (1) *They lost their momentum*
- (2) *There were sparks between us*
- (3) *Look how far we've come*
- (4) *We're at a crossroad*
- (5) *He overpowered her*
- (6) *I could feel the electricity between them*
- (7) *We'll just have to go our separate ways*
- (8) *We can't turn back now*
- (9) *His whole life revolves around her*
- (10) *She is besieged by suitors*
- (11) *They are uncontrollably attracted to each other*
- (12) *He is known for his conquests*

Can you think of other metaphors that do not fit into the above three schemas?

2. Match the metonymy with its type

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| a. The ham sandwich wants the bill. | i. PART FOR WHOLE |
| b. She drank the whole bottle. | ii. ATTRIBUTE FOR PERSON |
| c. Oxford published a new dictionary. | iii. OBJECT FOR USER |
| d. All hands on deck. | iv. PLACE FOR INSTITUTION |
| e. The university raised tuition. | v. CONTAINER FOR CONTENT |
| f. The suits approved the merger. | vi. INSTITUTION FOR PEOPLE |

3. For any two languages that you know, discuss similarities and differences in conventionalized metaphors of body parts (e.g. *hand of a watch*, *kao-ga hiroi* "well-known (lit: face is wide)").

Some Czech Examples

Metonymy in Czech

- (13) *Dvojka u okna chce zaplatit.*
'The table of two by the window wants to pay.'
(OBJECT FOR USER)
- (14) *Vypila celou láhev.*
'She drank the whole bottle.'
(CONTAINER FOR CONTENT)
- (15) *Oxford vydal nový slovník.*
'Oxford published a new dictionary.'
(PLACE FOR INSTITUTION)
- (16) *Všechny ruce na palubu!*
'All hands on deck!'
(PART FOR WHOLE)
- (17) *Univerzita zvýšila školné.*
'The university raised tuition.'
(INSTITUTION FOR PEOPLE)
- (18) *Obleky schválily fúzi.*
'The suits approved the merger.'
(ATTRIBUTE FOR PERSON)
- (19) *Čtu Kunderu.*
'I'm reading Kundera.'
(PRODUCER FOR PRODUCT)
- (20) *Poslouchám Mozarta.*
'I'm listening to Mozart.'
(PRODUCER FOR PRODUCT)
- (21) *Praha jedná s Bruselem.*
'Prague is negotiating with Brussels.'
(PLACE FOR GOVERNMENT / INSTITUTION)
- (22) *Potřebujeme víc hlav.*
'We need more heads.'
(PART FOR WHOLE)

Metaphor in Czech

- (23) *Nosím kontaktní čočky.*
'I wear contact lenses.'
(*čočka* = 'lentil' / 'lens')
- (24) *Osvětlil nám ten problém.*
'He shed light on that problem.'
(KNOWLEDGE IS LIGHT)
- (25) *Čeká nás světlá budoucnost.*
'A bright future awaits us.'
(GOOD IS LIGHT)
- (26) *Jsou v ponuré náladě.*
'They are in a gloomy mood.'
- (27) *Je na dně.*
'He's at rock bottom.'
(GOOD IS UP)
- (28) *Morálka stoupla.*
'Morale rose.'
- (29) *Jde do hloubky.*
'He goes into depth.'
(UNDERSTANDING IS DEPTH)
- (30) *Má hluboké znalosti češtiny.*
'She has deep knowledge of Czech.'
- (31) *To byl povrchní výklad.*
'That was a superficial explanation.'